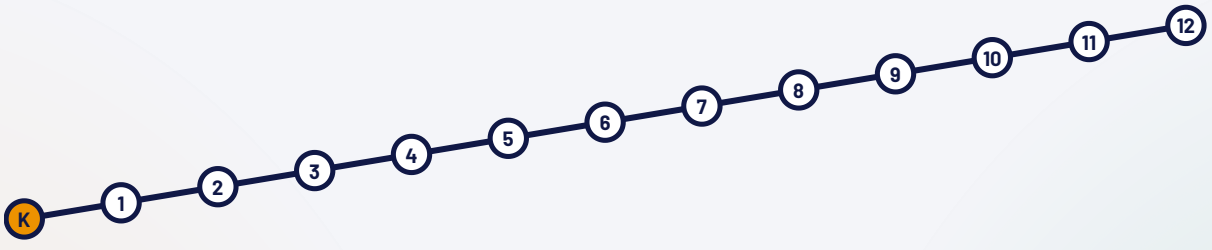
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: Grades 9–12

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12, with questions and options for our part in the story.



These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade (2,709 ratings, completed November 2026), not what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

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Each part follows the same path: the picture (charts), what the numbers say, what we notice, questions for us, and our part in the story (options for improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). The data behind each item is shown in brackets, and each item links to the matching page of the Vertical Alignment site. 16 pages, A4. The bookmarks jump to each part.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

About the data

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part gives the key data, the patterns we see in it, questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story.

> **These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers.** They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part gives the key data, the patterns we see in it, questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story.

Where the numbers come from. Every figure is computed from the ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings, last rating 8 November) and checked against the Vertical Alignment reports and findings decks.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between: some classes, or taught briefly (for example, 3 of 5 classes)
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Four things to hold in mind while reading.

- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught across a whole grade. They are not a measure of what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read that more or less strictly, so a low figure can reflect a stricter reading, not less teaching. Where this matters most, the paper says so. Where a team rated nothing in depth, we read it as careful use of an all-or-nothing scale, not as an absence of teaching.
- Each team rated its own subject's standards. Much literacy (vocabulary, academic language, speaking, writing, reading non-fiction) is also taught through Science and Social Studies, and that teaching may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of the main grade-level ratings (one standard in one grade). Essential Elements (the alternate standards) are counted apart.

We cannot teach everything equally. No school can take every standard to depth, and that is not the goal. The goal is to choose on purpose: which standards we teach in depth, which we introduce, and which we leave out, and to plan that proportion together across the grades. The ratings show the mix we have now, so we can decide the mix we want.

Instructional capacity. How many standards a grade actually takes to depth, introduces or leaves out in a year, worked out from the ratings (the average for one grade). It is not a target and not a judgement: it describes what our teaching time holds now, so we can decide together how to use it.

Themes. In every part, the facts, patterns and questions are grouped under the same themes, in the same order: The big picture, Strands and topics, Across grades and schools, Priority and power standards, Essential Elements, Gaps and placement, How we read the scale, Capacity and choices, Literacy across subjects and Background. Each item shows its theme, so a team can follow one theme across the whole school, its band and its subject.

How each part is laid out. Key data first, then patterns and comparisons, then questions to ponder, then options for our part in the story (improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). Every pattern carries its figures in the text, and every question ends with the data behind it, in brackets and italics. The questions are invitations, not conclusions. Our strengths are named alongside the places where we might build.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **No grade teaches it (confirmed).** Every grade that could teach the standard rated it not taught.
- **Not taught where placed.** The grade it was placed in rated it not taught, and other grades that could teach it were not asked.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.
- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Instructional capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.

- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught. They do not measure what students know or can do.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school standards were placed in grades and courses by suggestion. "Not taught" there can mean "taught in another year". 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also not taught in the grade where they were placed.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.

ABOUT THE DATA

Download as PDF

> **What you are seeing.** Printable A4 copies of this walkthrough: the whole thing, each grade band and each subject. Each one starts with How to read the data.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** Teams can take their own band or subject into a meeting, print it, and write on it.

1. **The whole walkthrough, K-12** Download PDF ↓
2. **Elementary, K-5** Download PDF ↓
3. **Middle school, Grades 6-8** Download PDF ↓
4. **High school, Grades 9-12** Download PDF ↓
5. **Math, K-12** Download PDF ↓
6. **ELA, K-12** Download PDF ↓
7. **Science, K-12** Download PDF ↓
8. **Social Studies, K-12** Download PDF ↓

ABOUT THE DATA

The data on the Vertical Alignment site

Coverage map ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗ Grade dashboards ↗ Priority and power (Audit) ↗
Reports and Excel downloads ↗

High school, Grades 9–12

In Grades 9-12, teachers reported that 63% of the 575 grade-level ratings (377 standards) are at least introduced, and 28% are taught in depth, the highest of the three bands. ELA (51%) and Science (48%) are both strong, and Grade 10 Science has the highest share in depth of any grade and subject (79%).

28%	63%	37%	575
taught in depth	at least introduced	not taught	grade-level ratings

What you are seeing. Four headline figures for this part: the share taught in depth, at least introduced and not taught, and how many ratings they come from.

What it adds to our story. This is the starting picture for this part. The slides that follow show where these numbers come from and what they might mean for us.

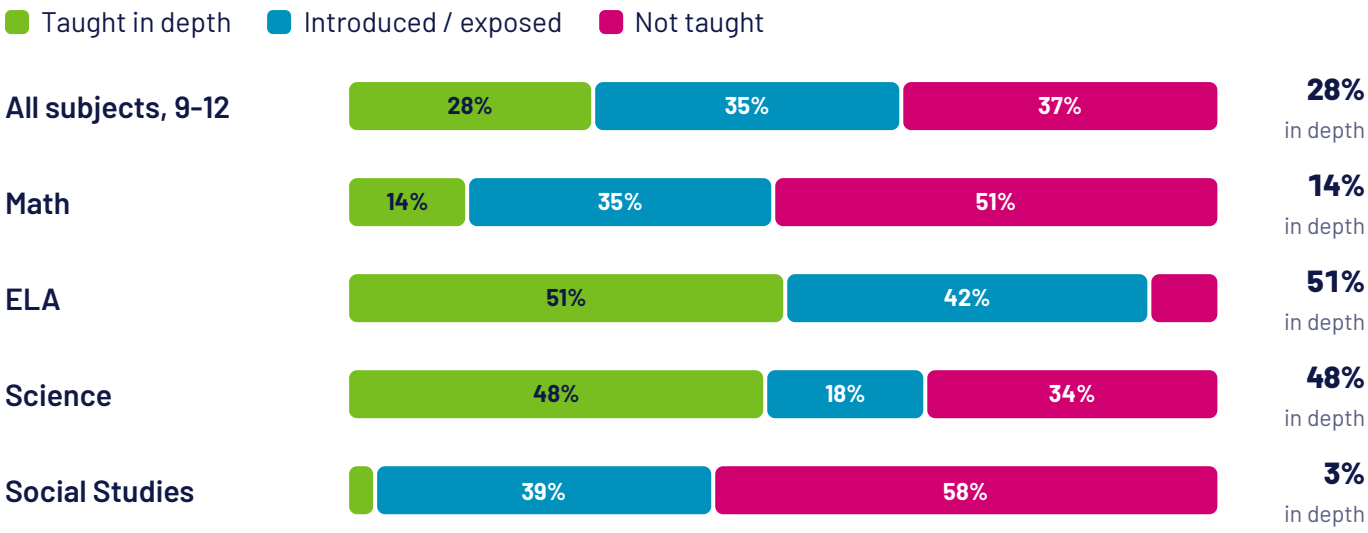
These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

THE PICTURE

At a glance

What you are seeing. Each bar shows all the ratings for one subject: green is taught in depth, blue is introduced, pink is not taught.

What it adds to our story. High school goes deepest of the three bands, led by ELA and Science.



How to read this: each bar is 100% of the grade-level ratings. Green is taught in depth, blue is introduced or exposed, pink is not taught. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

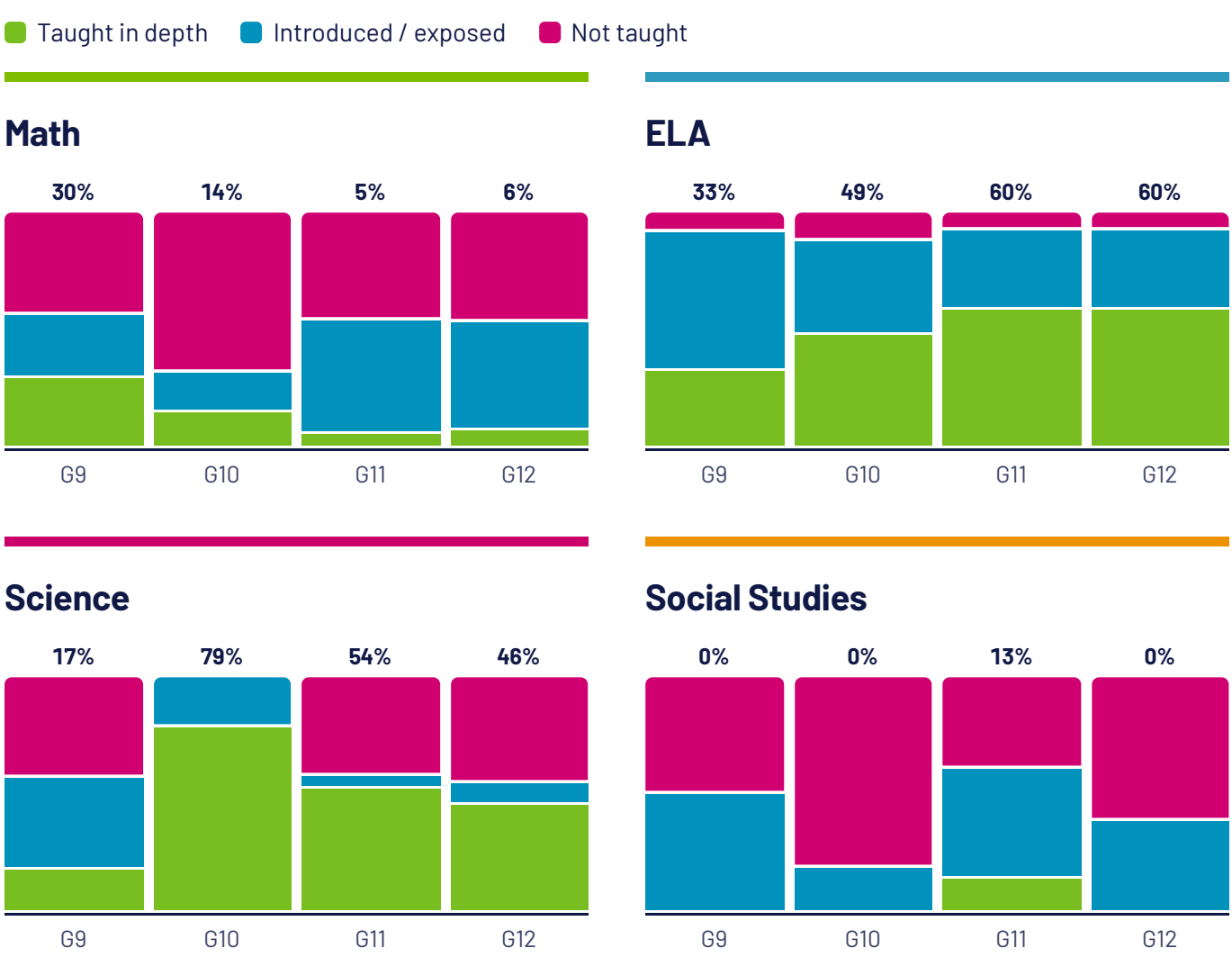
Share in depth	G9	G10	G11	G12	9-12
Math	30%	14%	5%	6%	14%
ELA	33%	49%	60%	60%	51%
Science	17%	79%	54%	46%	48%
Social Studies	0%	0%	13%	0%	3%
All subjects	24%	32%	34%	23%	28%

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column for each grade. The number on top is the share of that grade's standards taught in depth.

What it adds to our story. ELA builds year on year, and Math is strongest in Grade 9. The picture is mostly about choices between courses.



How to read this: for each subject, one column per grade, with the share taught in depth on top.

Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗

WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY

Key data

What you are seeing. The main facts from the ratings, in plain numbers. Each one links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

What it adds to our story. Few standards are missing everywhere. Most open questions are about which course teaches what.

Themes: The big picture · Strands and topics

1. THE BIG PICTURE **The band in three numbers.** 162 ratings in depth (28%), 203 introduced (35%), 210 not taught (37%). Coverage map ↗

2. THE BIG PICTURE **ELA reaches almost everything.** 92% of ELA standards are at least introduced, the highest coverage of any subject in any band. Only 14 of 180 ratings are not taught. Coverage map ↗

3. THE BIG PICTURE **Math starts strong and thins.** 30% in depth in Grade 9, then 14%, 5% and 6%. Across the band, 51% of Math ratings are not taught. Grade 9 dashboard ↗

4. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Speaking and Listening is at 100% in Grades 11 and 12.** Reading is at 78% in both. Coverage map ↗

Themes: Strands and topics

5. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Grade 10 Science.** 79% in depth and nothing rated not taught. All 15 Physical Science standards are in depth. Grade 10 dashboard ↗

6. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Science strands.** Physical Science 88% in depth, Life Science 50%, Earth and Space 21%, Engineering 19%. Coverage map ↗

7. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Grade 9 algebra is a strength.** Reasoning with Equations and Inequalities is 60% in depth in Grade 9, Creating Equations 50%, The Real Number System 100%. Coverage map ↗

8. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Math strands not yet rated in depth.** Trigonometric Functions, Similarity and Trigonometry, Conditional Probability, Making Inferences, Using Probability, Vectors and Matrices, Circles, Geometric Measurement, Building Functions, Linear, Quadratic and Exponential Models, and Expressing Geometric Properties (11 of 21 strands). Coverage map ↗

Themes: Strands and topics · Across grades and schools

9. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Social Studies.** 3 of 106 ratings are in depth, all in Grade 11 Economics. Grade 10 rates 82% not taught. Coverage map ↗

10. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **ELA builds year on year.** 33% in depth in Grade 9, 49% in Grade 10, 60% in Grades 11 and 12. Coverage map ↗

11. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Progressions.** In this band, 2 of 37 ELA, Math and Science progressions break down on an official link, and 21 of 29 ELA progressions are taught at every step. In the K-12 view, two Math progressions break at Grade 9 and three Social Studies inquiry progressions stop after Grade 6. Progressions ↗

12. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Hand-overs in.** 20 high school standards taught in depth build on an earlier-school standard rated not taught: ELA 9, Science 6, Math 3, Social Studies 2. Progressions ↗

Themes: Priority and power standards · Essential Elements · Gaps and placement

13. PRIORITY AND POWER STANDARDS **Priority standards.** 38% of priority ratings are in depth, against 28% for all standards. Science 55%, ELA 54%, Math 27%, Social Studies 2%. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

14. ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS **Math Essential Elements.** 54% of high school Math Essential Element ratings are not taught (32 of 59). Grade 12 Math rates 64 standards, the most of any grade and subject. Grade 12 dashboard ↗

15. GAPS AND PLACEMENT **Few confirmed gaps.** Only 7 standards are confirmed as taught by no grade. A further 119 are not taught in the course where they were placed, with other grades not asked (Math 77, Social Studies 22, Science 20). Gaps and repetition ↗

16. GAPS AND PLACEMENT **Introduced, never in depth.** 128 standards are introduced and never in depth: Math 52, Social Studies 36, ELA 29, Science 11. Gaps and repetition ↗

WHAT WE NOTICE

Patterns, trends and comparisons

What you are seeing. What we notice when we put the facts side by side: rises, dips and comparisons. These are possibilities to talk about, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. Steady, planned sequences (like ELA) lead to depth, and the SAT areas in Math deserve a closer look.

Themes: The big picture · Strands and topics

1. THE BIG PICTURE **High school is our most settled band.** It has the highest share in depth, the fewest confirmed gaps (7) and the fewest ELA and Science breaks. The picture here is less about holes and more about choices between courses. Gaps and repetition ↗

2. THE BIG PICTURE **ELA and Math move in opposite directions.** ELA depth nearly doubles from Grade 9 to Grade 12 (33% to 60%). Math depth falls from 30% to 6% over the same years. Coverage map ↗

3. STRANDS AND TOPICS **The Math that is deep is algebra, a large part of SAT Math.** Grade 9 equations and functions are the strongest part of high school Math. The SAT's other areas are thinner: data and statistics strands are at or near 0%, and geometry and trigonometry sit under 10% apart from Congruence (31%). Grade 9 dashboard ↗

Themes: Strands and topics

4. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Strong Physical Science sits on thin foundations.** Six high school Science standards taught in depth build on K-5 standards that no K-5 grade teaches. Five of those are Physical Science. Progressions ↗

5. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Language is the thinnest ELA strand again.** 30% in depth, against 54% to 69% for the other strands. It is also the thinnest strand in K-5 (10%). Coverage map ↗

6. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Social Studies inquiry is not yet taught.** All 10 Inquiry standards are rated not taught in both Grade 9 and Grade 10. Grade 9 Geography is the exception in coverage: 92% introduced. Coverage map ↗

Themes: Across grades and schools · Priority and power standards

7. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Grades 9 and 10 build; Grades 11 and 12 match exactly.** Grades 9 and 10 rate the same 43 ELA standards but agree on only 18: Grade 9 introduces and Grade 10 deepens, like a two-year sequence. Grades 11 and 12 gave identical ratings on all 47 shared standards (28 in depth in both), which is worth confirming. Coverage map ↗

8. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Grade 9 is a landing year.** ELA falls from 50% in Grade 8 to 33%, and Science from 43% to 17%, while Math rises from 0% to 30%. Grade 9 Writing is at 15% against 77% in Grade 10. Coverage map ↗

9. PRIORITY AND POWER STANDARDS **Priority Math is deepest in Grades 9 and 10.** In Grade 9, 75% of priority Math standards are in depth, and in Grade 10, 41%. In Grades 11 and 12 the figure is 13% and 9%. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

Themes: Essential Elements · Gaps and placement

10. ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS **Essential Elements in Social Studies outpace the main standards.** 22% in depth against 3%. In Science they are also slightly ahead (55% against 48%). Coverage map ↗

11. GAPS AND PLACEMENT **"Not taught" often means "not in this course".** High school standards were placed in courses by suggestion. The 119 standards not taught where placed may be taught in another year, or belong to a course few students take. This is worth settling before anything is called a gap. Gaps and repetition ↗

12. GAPS AND PLACEMENT **Science depth follows the course map.** Grade 10 is Physical Science (100% in depth), Grade 11 is Life Science (50%), Grade 9 is Earth and Space (21%). Grade 9 is the quietest Science year at 17%. Coverage map ↗

Themes: Capacity and choices · Literacy across subjects

13. CAPACITY AND CHOICES **What a high school grade carries in a year.** A high school grade takes about 41 standards to depth across its four subjects (about 10 per subject), introduces about 51 and does not teach about 53, out of about 144 rated. By subject, per grade: ELA about 23 in depth of 45 rated, Science 10 of 21, Math 7 of 52, Social Studies 1 of 27. As shares of each subject's standards: ELA 51% in depth, 42% introduced, 8% not taught; Math 14% in depth, 35% introduced, 51% not taught; Science 48% in depth, 18% introduced, 34% not taught; Social Studies 3% in depth, 39% introduced, 58% not taught. Capacity here means how many standards a grade's teaching time actually holds in a year. It is not a target and not a judgement. Coverage map ↗

14. LITERACY ACROSS SUBJECTS **Science and Social Studies as literacy.** High school Science (48% in depth) uses reading, data and argument writing that ELA standards describe. Social Studies inquiry (all 10 standards not taught in Grades 9 and 10) is close to the research ELA teaches in depth. Coverage map ↗

Questions and our part in the story

What you are seeing. Questions for teams to talk about. Each one shows the data that prompted it, and links to where that figure appears on this page.

What it adds to our story. These questions are about the end of the journey: what every graduate should leave with.

Themes: Strands and topics

1 STRANDS AND TOPICS **Which Math standards do our students most need for the SAT and the diploma, and are those the ones we take to depth?**

(Data: 14% of high school Math is in depth: algebra strands about 28%, data analysis about 3%, geometry and trigonometry about 7%.) see Pattern 13

Coverage map ↗

2 STRANDS AND TOPICS **Data, statistics and probability have almost no depth in high school Math. Is that a decision, and does it match what the SAT asks?**

(Data: 1 of 38 ratings in depth across the four statistics and probability strands.) see At a glance chart

Coverage map ↗

3 STRANDS AND TOPICS **Where could Social Studies inquiry skills be taught alongside the research and argument writing ELA already does in depth?**

(Data: all 10 Inquiry standards are not taught in Grades 9 and 10; ELA Reading is 61% and Writing 54% in depth.) see Key data 13

Coverage map ↗

4 STRANDS AND TOPICS **Is Language (grammar, usage, vocabulary) taught through writing in high school, and would teams rate it differently if so?**

(Data: Language is 30% in depth, against 54% to 69% for the other ELA strands.) see Pattern 5

Coverage map ↗

Themes: Across grades and schools

1 ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **What lets ELA build so steadily from Grade 9 to Grade 12, and how is that sequence agreed between teachers?**

(Data: ELA in depth 33%, 49%, 60%, 60%; 21 of 29 progressions taught at every step.) see Key data 10

Progressions ↗

2 ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **What would help Grade 9 feel less like a restart in ELA and Science?**

(Data: Grade 8 to Grade 9, ELA 50% to 33% and Science 43% to 17%; Grade 9 Writing is 15% in depth.) see Pattern 8

Coverage map ↗

3 ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Which one Grade 12 standard per subject should every graduate reach in depth, and which grade first takes it there?**

(Data: Grade 12 in depth: ELA 60%, Science 46%, Math 6%, Social Studies 0%.) see Pattern 2

Coverage map ↗

4 ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **What should middle school know about what high school finds on arrival?**

(Data: 20 high school standards in depth build on an earlier-school standard rated not taught: ELA 9, Science 6, Math 3, Social Studies 2.) see Key data 12

Progressions ↗

Themes: Priority and power standards · Gaps and placement

1 PRIORITY AND POWER STANDARDS **Grade 9 priority Math is strong. What would it take to carry that into Grades 10 to 12?**

(Data: Priority Math in depth: 75% in Grade 9, 41% in Grade 10, 13% in Grade 11, 9% in Grade 12.) see Pattern 9

Priority and power (Audit) ↗

2 GAPS AND PLACEMENT **For the 77 Math standards not taught where placed, are they taught in another course, or have we chosen to leave them?**

(Data: 51% of high school Math ratings are not taught, with no confirmed gaps.) see Key data 3

Gaps and repetition ↗

3 GAPS AND PLACEMENT **Which K-5 and middle school Physical Science ideas does Grade 10 wish students arrived with?**

(Data: all 15 Grade 10 Physical Science standards are in depth; five build on K-5 Physical Science standards no grade teaches.) see Key data 5

Progressions ↗

4 GAPS AND PLACEMENT **Do the standards on the site sit in the courses that teach them, and who should confirm the placements?**

(Data: 119 standards not taught where placed: Math 77, Social Studies 22, Science 20.) see Key data 15

Gaps and repetition ↗

Themes: Capacity and choices

1 CAPACITY AND CHOICES **Knowing a high school grade takes about 41 standards to depth a year, are those the standards our graduates most need, including for the SAT?**

(Data: Per Grade 9 to 12: about 41 in depth, 51 introduced, 53 not taught, out of 144 rated.) see Pattern 13

Grade 9 dashboard ↗

2 CAPACITY AND CHOICES **Which high school standards are we choosing to leave out, and is that choice written down for each course?**

(Data: 9-12 mix: 28% in depth, 35% introduced, 37% not taught.) see Key data 1

Coverage map ↗

Our part in the story

What you are seeing. Options for what we could do, under four headings, each with the data behind it.

What it adds to our story. This is where findings turn into action: small, shared steps we could take together.

Options to discuss and act on. Pick what fits your team, change it, or add your own.

Improving the curriculum

Could high school agree, course by course, which standards each course owns and which it leaves on purpose?

(Data: 119 standards not taught where placed: Math 77, Social Studies 22, Science 20.) see Key data 15

Gaps and repetition ↗

Working across grade levels

What if Grade 8 and Grade 9 teachers in ELA and Science planned the first unit of Grade 9 together?

(Data: Grade 8 to 9: ELA 50% to 33%, Science 43% to 17%.) see Pattern 8

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

Could high school Math share with middle school the five algebra ideas Grade 9 relies on most?

(Data: Three Grade 9 Math standards in depth build on Grade 6 and 8 standards rated not taught.)

Progressions ↗

A concrete action we could take

We might map high school Math against the SAT areas and choose which thin strands to deepen first.

(Data: Algebra about 28% in depth; data analysis about 3%; geometry and trigonometry about 7%.) see Key data 1

Coverage map ↗